

Am I allowed to be me?

Coming to terms with an awareness of one's identity

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Attention

Being seen, and looking. It runs both ways, and the inward direction is the one people skip.

What do you turn your attention towards? What in your own inner life still interests you?

LÄNGLE ASKS IT THIS WAY

By whom am I seen? Who considers my uniqueness and respects my boundaries?

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Justice

Being dealt with fairly. Knowing, without arguing yourself out of it, when you were not.

Where have you been dealt with fairly, and where have you not? What does that still ask of you?

LÄNGLE ASKS IT THIS WAY

Do people do me justice?

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Appreciation

Worth that does not have to be earned again every morning. Other people's, and your own.

What do you value in yourself? What would you want another person to see in you?

LÄNGLE ASKS IT THIS WAY

For what am I appreciated: for what can I appreciate myself? The sum of these experiences builds the self-esteem.

When it is missing: solitude, hysteria, and a need to hide behind shame.

How to use it

Four weeks, one Fundamental Motivation a week, in order. They build on one another: the second assumes the first, and the fourth assumes all three. It is worth keeping them in sequence.

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| 1. TUNE IN | Listen to the meditation for that Fundamental Motivation. Nothing to answer yet. |
| 2. SIT | Two or three minutes afterwards with nothing happening. This is part of it. |
| 3. REFLECT | Three questions, one per prerequisite. Write by hand if you can. |
| 4. LEAVE IT | Come back to the page later in the week and add what surfaced. The first answer is rarely the whole answer. |

Please listen to the meditation before you look at the questions. It is there to put you in contact with what the questions are about, so that the answers come from somewhere a little deeper than what you already think about yourself. Each meditation folds in the ones before it, and they get longer: fifteen minutes at the first, forty-five at the last. That lengthening is deliberate. It is gentle practice for holding your attention inwards for the kind of stretch a journey will ask of you.

IF A QUESTION COMES UP EMPTY

Some of these questions may come up empty, and that is worth as much as a full page. Perhaps more. An empty line is telling you something, and it does not require you to do anything about it today. You can just sit with it for now. And if several come up empty at once, or if what surfaces is more than you want to hold on your own, I encourage you to take it to someone before you take it into a journey: a therapist, a doctor, or a person who knows you well.

Two honest questions

What if I do not have four weeks?

Then do them in whatever time you have, still in order, even if that is four evenings. The order carries the argument; the calendar does not. But notice that wanting to compress the preparation is itself worth a line on the page.

What if I am not planning a journey at all?

The twelve conditions are not about psychedelics. They are Längle's account of what a person needs in order to say yes to their own life, and they were being asked in consulting rooms for decades before anyone pointed them at this. Use them anyway.



The four meditations

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